



WINDOWS MOBILE 5

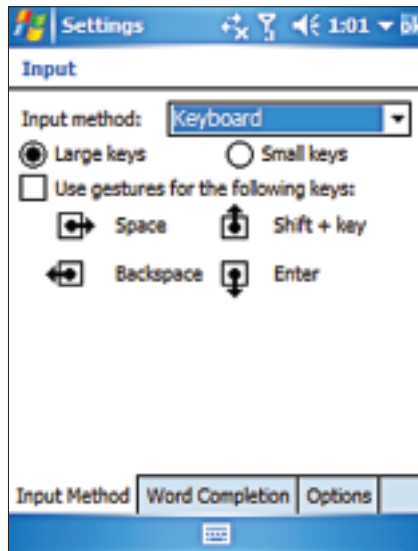
Prices for Windows Mobile phones have dropped well under the Rs 15,000 mark, and there could be no better time to get you one. Here we are, back with more tips for your Windows Mobile 5 handheld.

Multitasking

Multitasking in Windows on a Desktop is no problem, but with Windows Mobile, what do you do? Go to Start > Settings > System > Memory > Running Programs. This is a really long way to do this. Probably the easiest way to switch programs is download a third party application such as Vbar, from www.vieka.com/vbar.htm. Uncompress the ZIP file and run it. On your mobile you'll be asked where to install the program. Start vBar from Start > Programs. You'll see a small icon at the right top of the screen. Click on it and you can quickly jump to any application—or easily close one or all the programs.

Getting A Bigger Onscreen Keyboard

For PocketPC users without a QWERTY keyboard, you'll be stuck with the touchscreen keyboard which, although fairly easy to use, has really small keys. There is an option to enable a bigger version of that keyboard. Click on the drop-down menu at the centre bottom of the screen. Click on Options. From the dropdown menu for Input Method,

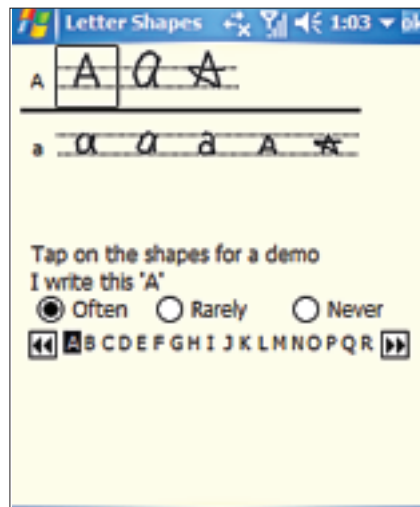
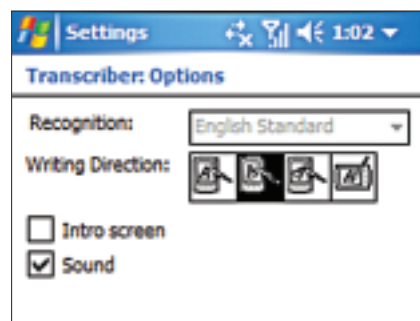


The larger keyboard in Windows Mobile is best suited for typing text messages.

select Keyboard. Click the Large keys radio button, then OK. You will now have the larger keyboard without the numerical keys. To access the other keys, click the 123 button.

Getting Transcriber To Work Better

The transcriber is easy and a very quick way to type in text, but most people don't find it to be very accurate. There are few things you can do to improve this. First enable the Transcriber by clicking on the drop-down menu of the input icon at the centre bottom of the screen. Click on Options in the same menu. Click on Options for the Transcriber. The first thing you tell it is the direction you normally write on it. Choose from one of the four options. Then click on the Inking tab. Click Match Letter Shapes to your writing. Here, for every letter, you can select the style that you write in, and you can



The transcriber can be tweaked to your writing style

select whether you always use that style or sometimes or never. Do the same for all the letters and for upper and lower cases. When done, you can choose to save that profile by selecting File, entering a filename, and clicking Save.

Alternative Browsers

There's Internet Explorer on your Windows Mobile phone, but you can have third-party browsers installed. Two of the most known ones are the Opera Mobile browser, which is commercial—but it supports tabs. The free alternative is Opera Mini, a Java application. The latest release is 4, and can be downloaded for free from www.operamini.com.

Disable SMS Sent Confirmation Messages

You can disable that message by making a few changes to the registry. Download a registry editor for Windows mobile such as PHM Registry Editor (<http://www.phm.lu/Products/PocketPC/RegEdit/>) or Mobile Registry Editor (http://www.breaksoft.com/Blog/Utilities/2005/1/Mobile_Registry_Editor.aspx). Once you have one installed, go to HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Inbox\Settings. Here, double-click SMSNoSentMsg Dword and enter its value as 1. To enable it again, set the value to 0.

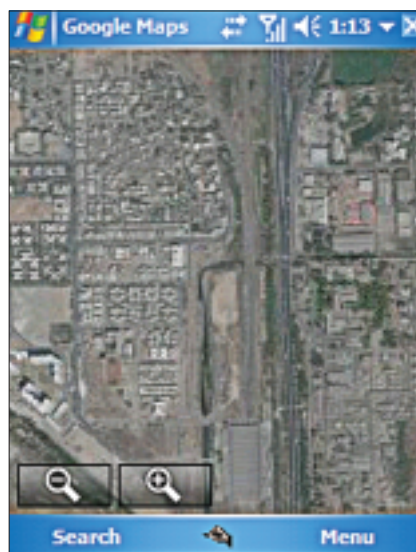
Getting Rid Of Entries In The Start Menu

Sometimes, you might uninstall a program without shutting it down completely, or something might go wrong during the uninstall process—and you end up with an item in the Start menu that doesn't work. You could reinstall the program and then uninstall it again. The other way is to use the File Explorer and delete the entry from the \Windows\Start Menu folder. You may have to remove the entry from the registry as well.

Converting Your Phone Into A GPS Unit

Standalone GPS units are costly—normally well over Rs 10,000, but Bluetooth GPS receivers are much cheaper. Some of the cheapest GPS units can be around Rs 1,400, although availability in India can be a problem. Be sure your phone has Bluetooth.

Turn on the GPS receiver and the Bluetooth on your phone as well by going to Start > Settings > Connections > Comm Manager, and



Google Maps is one application that works well with a GPS receiver by guiding you everywhere you go.

then clicking on the Bluetooth icon. Next, in the Connection Settings window, click on Bluetooth and then on the Devices tab. Click Add new device... The phone will look for any Bluetooth devices in the area. Click on your GPS receiver and click Next. Enter a name for the device and the service—Serial Port, and click Next. Now click on COM Ports and then on New Outgoing Port. Select the device and click Next. Choose the port and click Finish.

Your GPS receiver setup is complete. Install free GPS software like Google Maps to show your location on the map. You will, obviously, need a GPRS

connection to download the maps. In Google Maps, select Menu > Track Location, and a little glowing circle will appear at the location. Select Menu > Track Location Settings to set the port and the baud rate manually if Google Maps doesn't detect it automatically.

SYMBIAN S60

Symbian leads the mobile phone OS market—much more than Microsoft with its Windows Mobile platform—mostly thanks to the complete domination of Nokia and Sony Ericsson in the Indian mobile phone space. Almost every mid-ranged phone has the Symbian S60 OS running on it, which is why we've compiled yet another list of simple as well as advanced tips for it. We tried these out on a Nokia N73, but they should work just fine with almost all Symbian S60 based phones.

Select Apps By Pressing A Number

Launching applications is a pain, and scrolling through the list using the joystick makes it even more painful. When you switch to the main menu, the easiest way to go around applications and run them is to directly press the number of the application. For example, the left topmost application is 1, the right topmost one is 3, and so on. If you don't like the grid-styled view, you can move to the list view: go to Options > Change View > List. The shortcuts can be used here as well, with the topmost item being 1 and the ones below 2, 3, 4, etc.

Quick-launching The Media Player

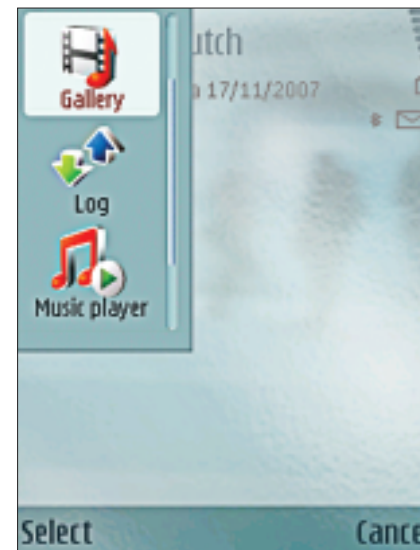
On most Nokia phones, you'll find a dedicated Media button which, when pressed, gives you the list of multimedia applications. To launch your default media player, simply hold down the key and it will open directly. You can go about adding music tracks and playing them.

Launching The Browser Using A Single Key

Many phones have a dedicated Internet button. The (i) button on some phones might not do much other than entering the number. Hold down the same button for a longer period and you'll find that the default browser loads up.

Multitasking In Symbian

We love to Alt-Tab between applications because it makes life easier—it's lucky Symbian-based phones have this feature as well. The Menu key, which normally launches the menu of applications, if held down for a longer



Multitasking is built into most Symbian phones

period, shows a list of open applications currently being run (on the left). You can scroll and use the application, and shut them down if you want to.

Entering A New Line

While we type messages or notes, we often want to start a new paragraph or new line. Pressing 0 only enters a space, and if you press it again, the number 0. To start a new line, press the 0 key thrice!

Voice-mail Setup

The default key for voice mail is 1. Hold down the 1 key and you will be able to access your voice mail. It's very likely it won't be set up by default, so the first time you do this, you'll be required to enter the voice mail number.

Speed-dial Setup

Speed-dial numbers are a single-button-press shortcut to call up those you call most often without accessing the phonebook. It can be done by holding down the number you want. If you haven't set up speed dial, hold down the number you want to use. It will ask you to assign a number. Choose Yes. Next, select the number from the list and choose Select. The number 1 is usually dedicated to voice mail, and the number 0 for services.

Flickr On Nokia Phones

Nokia has joined hands with Flickr with their N series phones. This collaboration allows Nokia users to quickly click, upload, and access photos from Flickr through their phone without using a computer. To log into Flickr, go to the Gallery and then to Images & Video. Choose Options and then Open Online service. If you don't see an option to create

